Charl L. Brill

Senior Data Engineer

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SUMMARY

Senior Data Engineer with more than ten years in data engineering, analytics consulting and data product leadership across Canada and South Africa. I design and build lakehouse platforms and ETL/ELT pipelines on Microsoft Fabric, Databricks, AWS and Azure, and I focus on data that people trust enough to use. A mechanical engineering degree and an MBA mean I'm comfortable moving between the technical detail and the business case.

SKILLS

Platforms	Microsoft Fabric, Azure Databricks, Azure (Data Factory, Key Vault, DevOps), AWS (Glue, Lambda, RDS, S3, Redshift)
Data engineering	SQL (PostgreSQL, MSSQL, MySQL), Python, PySpark, SparkSQL, dbt, ETL/ELT, medallion architecture, data modelling and warehousing
BI and analytics	Power BI, Qlik Sense, QlikView, Tableau, Metabase, Alteryx, KNIME, Mixpanel, forecasting and regression analysis
Ways of working	Agile (Scrum), Shape Up, Jira, Confluence, Git, product management, technical documentation

EXPERIENCE

Senior Data Engineer

Jul 2025 – Present

Data Elephant · Vancouver, Remote

- Turn client business requirements into data solutions on AWS, Azure and Databricks, and build end-to-end ETL/ELT pipelines in SQL, Python, PySpark and AWS Glue.
- Join pre-sales meetings and write client proposals, then keep delivery on track through clear communication and governance.
- Work with data scientists, MLOps engineers and full-stack developers in agile teams, contributing to DevOps practices and backend microservice improvements.
- Run pilots and proofs of concept for ML and AI use cases, and interview and assess candidates as the team grows.
- Write Data Elephant field guides on data engineering practice, including "Five Ways Teams Get Medallion Wrong".

Data Engineer

Oct 2023 – Jun 2025

Long View Systems · Vancouver, Hybrid · Retail, supply chain, insurance, SaaS

- Co-developed a deployable framework that ingests data from multiple source systems and streamlines reporting (Fabric, PySpark, SparkSQL, Power BI).
- Built an end-to-end medallion architecture on Microsoft Fabric Lakehouse with Azure Data Factory.
- Built monitoring solutions on Fabric and ADF from ingestion to reporting: call metrics, and inventory across the supply chain.
- Investigated Power BI migration options and built a REST API monitoring solution for Power BI deployments.
- Developed ETL pipelines in Databricks with SQL, and a Python module that rotates AES encryption keys through Azure Key Vault.

Head of Data Science and Analytics

Aug 2020 – Oct 2023

AgrigateOne · SaaS startup: agriculture, logistics, supply chain

- Launched and managed the data analytics and data science team, including budgeting, strategic planning and long-term growth.
- Product owner for all data analytics and data science features; wrote and shared roadmaps and managed stakeholder expectations.
- Designed the BI solution for growers and buyers on Metabase and PostgreSQL, with additional Power BI reporting.
- Designed the data warehouse on AWS (Lambda, RDS, S3) and delivered ML and process automation in Python.
- Led data strategy and digital transformation; ran delivery with Jira, Confluence, Shape Up and Git.

Business Intelligence Consultant
Apr 2019 – Jul 2020

Decision Inc. · Johannesburg · Retail, supply chain, mining

- Co-led the Advanced Analytics team (Alteryx, KNIME, Python): injury driver analysis for mining, sales forecasting, demand planning and procurement spend analysis.
- Deployed a big data Qlik model on AWS Redshift for a major South African retailer.
- Audited information landscapes in healthcare, retail, manufacturing and banking to align data strategy with corporate strategy.
- Built BI models in Power BI, Qlik Sense and QlikView, and started and led a company-wide data literacy programme.

Business Analyst
Jul 2014 – Sep 2017

Burlington Strategy Advisors · Corporate finance, asset management, property, rail

- Designed a capital portfolio optimisation algorithm for one of South Africa's largest capital portfolios (Excel VBA, C#).
- Built financial models for property development cash flows and for a large trigeneration project (heated water, chilled water and electricity).
- Implemented a large-scale KPI measurement system in Excel VBA.

Project Engineer (Head of Design Office)
Jan 2013 – Jun 2014

Mintek · Mining, engineering and design

- Led the design office and managed projects for pilot plant equipment and site layouts (AutoCAD, Inventor, SolidWorks).

EDUCATION

Master of Business Administration (MBA)
2018 – 2019

GIBS Business School, University of Pretoria

- 70% average. Thesis: *The influence of management support on the drivers of business intelligence success*.
- Exchange term at Kelley School of Business, Indiana University (2018): Predictive Analytics and Data Mining, New Product Management, International Business Environment.

Postgraduate Diploma in General Management, Cum Laude
2017 – 2018

GIBS Business School, University of Pretoria

- 78% average. Top student overall; highest mark in 5 of 12 subjects.

B.Eng Mechanical Engineering, Cum Laude
2009 – 2012

Stellenbosch University

- 80.2% average. Graduated 2nd in class; Golden Key International Honour Society.

CERTIFICATIONS

- Microsoft Certified: Fabric Data Engineer Associate (2025)
- Microsoft Certified: Fabric Analytics Engineer Associate (2024)
- dbt Fundamentals (2025)
- Microsoft Certified: Azure Fundamentals (2023)
- Databricks: Generative AI Fundamentals (2023)

Languages: English, Afrikaans · **References:** available on request